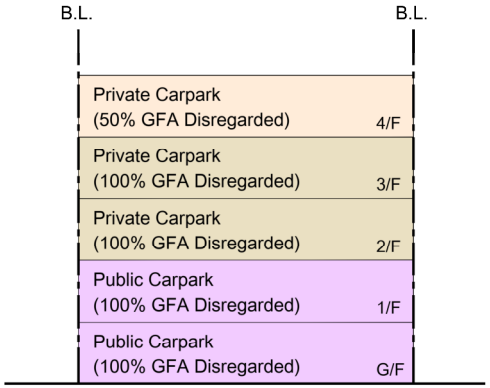
Summary of Items Discussed in APSEC Discussion Forum (ADF) 3/2026 on 14 August 2026

	Items proposed by Convenors for Discussion	Summary of Discussion and BD's Response
	Items raised by HKIA	
1.	**<u>Amenity Features under PNAP APP-42</u>** The following amenity features under PNAP APP-42 aim to promote elderly friendly built environment: Paragraph 20 – Horizontal Screens / Covered Walkways; Paragraph 24 – Shelters for Outdoor Fixed Seats; Paragraph 30 – Covered Areas at Public Open Space; Paragraph 42 – Covered Picking Up and Setting Down Area for Passengers. However, paragraph 46 of the PNAP currently stipulates that these features are applicable to residential and composite buildings, as well as commercial buildings often patronised by the elderly only. We opine that these amenity features should also be applicable to other building types, specifically institutional buildings (e.g. community facilities, health care centres and educational facilities). Generally, designated public and common areas within institutional developments are often utilised by elderly persons as well. The provisions of common covered walkways and outdoor sheltered seating also directly serve elderly visitors attending day-care services, medical appointments or accessing public open space in institutional buildings.	BD advised that the amenity features in paragraphs 20, 24, 30 and 42 under PNAP APP-42 which aim to promote elderly friendly built environment were applicable to residential and composite buildings, as well as commercial buildings often patronised by the elderly. For the above amenity features in other types of buildings, such as institutional buildings with residential care home for the elderly or day care centre which were often patronised by and were genuinely beneficial to the elderly, BD would favourably consider exempting such features from GFA and/or SC calculations on individual merits.

	Therefore, would BD clarify whether favorable consideration for gross floor area (GFA) / site coverage (SC) concessions for these amenity features under PNAP APP-42 can be given on case-by-case basis for other building types including institutional buildings, subject to AP's detailed justification regarding expected elderly usage and public benefit?	
	Items raised by HKIE	
2.	**<u>Wind Load on Canopy with Height Greater Than Two Times The Canopy Projection</u>** In Clause B2.3 of Appendix B to the Code of Practice on Wind Effects in Hong Kong 2019 (the Wind Code), there is a limit on the height of canopy to twice the canopy projection for the adoption of the recommended C_p values. Would BD please advise if the C_p values in this clause can be adopted in case the height limit is exceeded? If not, what procedures should be followed in assessing the wind load on the canopy?	BD advised that Clause B2.3 of Appendix B to the Wind Code could be referred to if the concerned canopy was attached below half-way up the building and below a height of twice the canopy projection. Clause B2.3 of Explanatory Notes to the Wind Code could be referred to for canopy attached to upper half of the building or free-standing canopy. Canopy is defined in regulation 2 under the Building (Planning) Regulations that any structure which projects more than 500 mm from any wall of any building and at a height of not more than 7.5 m above the level of the ground to provide protection from rain or sun, not carrying any floor load, either cantilevered or supported by brackets. In this case, the net pressure coefficients could be taken as +0.9 and -1.3 according to Clause B2.3 of Appendix B of the Wind Code.

3.	**Allowable Lateral Bearing Pressure of Rock With Allowable Vertical Bearing Pressure Conforming To The Recommendations in Technical Guidance Note No. 53** According to paragraph 6 of Appendix C to PNAP APP-18, allowable vertical bearing pressure for Category 1(c) granitic rock may be taken as 7500 kPa subject to certain imposed conditions by the BA. It is specified in Clause 2.2.2(3) of the Code of Practice for Foundations 2017 (2024 Edition) (the Foundation Code) that the allowable lateral bearing pressure of rock may be taken as 1/3 of the vertical bearing pressure provided that no adverse rock joints exist. It can thus be interpreted that if 7500 kPa is adopted for the allowable vertical bearing pressure of rock, then the allowable lateral bearing pressure may be taken as 7500/3 =2500 kPa. Would BD please advise if the above interpretation is correct?	BD advised that HKIE's understanding was correct provided that no adverse rock joints exist.
4.	**Concurrent Processing of Approval and Consent for Amendment of Secondary Structural Element Without First Consent** Regarding an amendment plan for secondary structural elements, for which first consent has not been granted, submitted to BA for approval, can the concurrent processing of approval and consent as stated in paragraph 34 of PNAP ADM-19 be adopted? Concerns have been raised in some cases that as first consent for the works has not been granted, the concurrent processing of approval and consent should not apply. Would BD please advise?	BD advised that according to paragraphs 33 and 34 of PNAP ADM-19, concurrent application for approval of plans and consent to the commencement of secondary structural element works does not limit to the first plan submission for these works, provided that the criteria set out in paragraph 34(a) to (d) of the PNAP were met.

5.	**<u>Arrangement for Rebound Hammer Test</u>** We note that the arrangement for rebound hammer tests for superstructure works has recently been changed such that tests are now conducted without prior notice. This has slowed the progress, as preparation of test surfaces could not be completed in advance. Additionally, as the technically competent person (TCP) of grade T3 of RSE's stream was not necessarily stationed full-time at site during the superstructure construction period, the requirement for TCP T3 attendance at short notice to witness and endorse test results has caused inconvenience to the personnel involved. Would BD please clarify the current arrangement for rebound hammer tests?	BD advised that according to paragraph 3 of PNAP ADM-18 on site auditing for building works, BD would conduct surprise checks to audit building works without prior notification. The auditing officer of BD would have the discretion to determine the timing of audit inspection subject to the nature of various stages of building works on a case-by-case basis.
	Items raised by AAP	
6.	**<u>The Code of Practice for Fire Safety in Buildings 2011 (2024 Edition) (FS Code) - Access to Maintenance Roof by Required Staircase</u>** For a building with two or more required staircases, it is our understanding that it is not necessary for those required staircases serving the floors immediately below the main roof for maintenance only to be continued to such main roof, provided that:- a) Access to other required staircase on the roof is not required under Clause B8.2 of the FS Code; b) The main roof is not regarded as refuge floor of the building under	BD advised that AAP's understanding was correct.

	Clause B18.3 of the FS Code ; and c) Other relevant provisions are complied with, such as access to the roof for maintenance or repair. Would BD please advise if the above understanding is correct.	
7.	**<u>PNAP APP-2 – Aboveground Private/ Public Car Park</u>** According to paragraph 18(b)(i) of PNAP APP-2, GFA for both aboveground private car park and aboveground public car park of not more than two floors can be 100% disregarded. Would BD please clarify if the 100% disregarded GFA for private car park and public car park are counted separately with not more than two floors for each respective use as illustrated in the diagram below.  	BD advised that AAP's diagram indicating the percentage of GFA concessions for the aboveground car parks was incorrect. Paragraph 7 and its footnote 4 of Appendix C to PNAP APP-2 stated that under paragraph 18(b)(i) of this PNAP, not more than two aboveground carparking floors (irrespective of the provision of private and public car parks) might be 100% disregarded from GFA calculation.

8.	**PNAP APP-93** According to paragraph 3(b)(ii) under PNAP APP-93, it is stated that the area of pipe wells could be exempted from the GFA calculations and open pipe wells may also be exempted from SC calculations. We understand that pipe well is also allowed to be covered provided that the relevant pipe well area is included in the SC calculation. Would BD please advise if the above understanding is correct?	BD advised that AAP's understanding was correct, subject to compliance with the criteria set in PNAP APP-93, especially the ventilation openings with a minimum net area of $1/10^{th}$ of the horizontal area of the pipe well at both the top and bottom of the well.
	Items raised by ACEHK	
9.	**Enhancement to Site Supervision** Further to the Joint BSC & APSEC meeting held on 12 June 2026, a working group for enhancement to site supervision has been established. Can BD give us an idea of the envisaged timeline for the working group and new requirements to be implemented? Also, as a general principle, will the new requirements only affect new projects (BA4 yet submitted) since some consultancies have already been awarded with site supervision fee as part of the lump sum fee.	BD advised that the proposal to enhance the site supervision by AP, RSE, RGE and registered contractors, together with the implementation arrangement would be discussed in the working group meetings. The first meeting would be conducted soon. [**Post-meeting note**: The first meeting of the working group was held on 2 September 2026.]
	Items raised by AREC	
10.	**Structural Submission for Maintenance Platforms** Would BD please advise whether there are any established guidelines or criteria governing the necessity of structural submissions for maintenance platforms within the E&M plant rooms?	BD advised that except for minor works commenced under the simplified requirements and building works exempted under section 41 of the BO, no person shall commence or carry out any building works without having

		obtained a prior approval and consent from the BA. Nevertheless, the self-certification system with fast track processing procedures for plan submissions of simple structural works under PNAP ADM-23 might be considered, provided that the relevant eligibility criteria were fulfilled.
11.	**<u>Use of Tied-Back Wall Support System for Excavation Works</u>** Paragraph 10 of the Information Note of LandsD attached to BD's circular letter dated 7 July 2026 states that for ground reinforcements encroaching into Government land within a public road, street or footpath or future public road, street or footpath maintained or to be maintained by HyD, HyD would be the authority to consider and approve the Works. In this regard, would BD accept the submission of ELS plan for the use of temporary ground reinforcements within such Government land, provided that these temporary ground reinforcements are installed at a specified depth below the existing road/street/footpath level? Furthermore, if BD does accept such ELS scheme, would the workflow set out in Appendix II to the Information Note remain applicable?	BD advised that while BD's processing of plan submission that involves ground reinforcements encroaching into Government land, including public roads, streets or footpaths currently maintained by HyD, BD will consult the relevant government departments under the centralised processing system and collate their comments within time limits allowed for processing the plan. In view of the above, the workflow set out in Appendix II to the LandsD's Information Note on streamlined arrangement for the use of ground reinforcements in adjoining Government Land for excavation works remains applicable. Additionally, AP/RSE/RGE might be required to apply for modification/exemption to exempt the provisions under section 31(1) of the BO for the approval of plans.
12.	**<u>Supporting Frame of Building Maintenance Unit (BMU)</u>** Would BD please advise whether the supporting frame of the BMU installed at the roof or upper roof level is subject to structural submission to BD?	BD advised that supporting frame of the BMU installed on the building required structural plan submission to the BA for approval. According to paragraph 3 in Appendix F to the Code of Practice on Access

		for External Maintenance 2021 (2024 Edition), structural details in respect of maintenance and repair access (e.g. cast-in anchors, restraint sockets, mechanical booms or anchorages for the temporary suspended working platform, etc.) should be submitted separately for approval.
	AOB Items	
13.	**<u>Enhancement in processing Structural Engineering Committee (SEC) Cases</u>** (Item raised by BD) To enhance the efficiency of processing SEC cases, the AP/RSE/RGE might choose to participate in the SEC meeting for presenting the case and recommendations, and answering SEC members' questions. Under this arrangement, the AP/RSE/RGE should prepare the SEC paper himself, in consultation with the case Senior Structrual Engineer (SSE) and submit the paper to the Secretary of SEC via the case SSE for circulation to SEC members before the meeting. Agreement with the respective Chief Structural Engineer should be sought in advance.	Members noted and supported.
14.	**<u>Building (Planning) (Amendment) Regulation 2026</u>** (Item raised by BD) Following the issuance of the revised PNAPs and Joint Practice Note for promoting elderly-friendly building design through incentives in 2025, the Building (Planning) (Amendment) Regulation 2026 (Amendment Regulation) was gazetted and tabled at the Legislative Council for vetting in May 2026. The Amendment Regulation was effective from 1 August 2026 and new PNAP	Members noted and supported.

APP-175 was issued on its implementation. BD briefed members on the mandatory elderly-friendly design requirements and the scope of application.

A summary table illustrating the application scope, albeit not exhaustive, is appended below for reference.

<table>
<tr><td colspan="4">Elderly-friendly Building Design Mandatory Requirements
(Applicable/ Not Applicable)</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="2">DOMESTIC BUILDING</td><td colspan="2">NON-DOMESTIC BUILDING</td></tr>
<tr><td>Residential Building/ Residential Area</td><td>Non-residential Building/ Non-residential Area</td><td>Commercial Building/ Commercial Area</td><td>Non-commercial Building/ Non-commercial Area</td></tr>
<tr><td>Private Residential Building</td><td rowspan="5">Hostel or Dormitory for lodging by pupils</td><td>Office</td><td>Industrial Building</td></tr>
<tr><td>Hotel</td><td>Shop</td><td>School</td></tr>
<tr><td>Residential care home for the elderly</td><td>Department Store</td><td>Independent/ Standalone Carpark</td></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="2">Transitional Housing and Light Public Housing</td><td>Place of Public Entertainment</td><td>Place used for bulk storage</td></tr>
<tr><td>Restaurant</td><td>Utility building</td></tr>
</table>

15.	**<u>Vote of Thanks</u>** (Item raised by BD) AD/NB1 proposed a vote of thanks to Mr KO Kiu-kin, Chief Building Surveyor/Kowloon, who attended this meeting for the last time prior to his transfer to a new post.	Members supported the vote of thanks to Mr KO.